

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's talk about the Seven Wonders of the World.



Learning Outcome

Describe detailed facts about events or actions in work and social contexts, in written or spoken situations.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about history and civilization.
- I can compare two related events or actions.
- I can talk about unusual or unique events in life.

Ask your partner:

- What wonders of the world, man-made or natural, can you name?
- Have you ever wanted to visit any of these places? Why or why not?





Let's Explore!

These buildings are **breathtaking***!

* When a building is "*breathtaking*" it's extremely exciting or surprising.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

If you think that people have just started making lists about the "the most" and "the best", you are wrong. We have only just imagined it to be a modern pastime. I have recently looked into the list the ancient Greeks made of the world's seven wonders.

Their purpose was to provide travelers with a better guide than they had previously had to the world's most fascinating and unique structures. They cited the Great Pyramid, the Hanging Gardens of Babylon, the Statue of Zeus at Olympia, the Temple of Artemis at Ephesus, the Mausoleum at Halicarnassus, the Colossus of Rhodes, and the Lighthouse of Alexandria.

Have you ever wondered why they chose seven? This is because in the ancient world, that number symbolized perfection. Have you ever noticed this list changes? It has recently changed again!

People are now voting on which seven buildings of the 200 still existing are more amazing than the others. Are these new structures more breathtaking than those the ancients chose? Perhaps not, especially if you consider how much more difficult it was in ancient times to erect such edifices than it was as time passed.

Also, if you think about how much longer the trip to see them was compared to the same journey today and how much more taxing travel over great distances was then compared to now, you must acknowledge that tourists were far more adventurous in ancient times than most are today.

I travel more than most people do. Even so, I have just visited three of the seven ancient sites. One more I have recently admired in a museum setting. Now that a more modern version is being put together, I will have to start a new bucket list.



**Let's Practice!**

The Seven Wonders have existed for a long time.

Instructions: Read the story on page 2 again. Select the correct answer.

- Which of these places is not one of the ancient Seven Wonders?
 - The Temple of Artemis.
 - The Colossus of Rhodes.
 - The Mausoleum of Halicarnassus.
 - The Sphinx of Memphis.
- Why did they choose seven wonders, and not another number?
 - Because seven symbolized good luck.
 - Because seven symbolized perfection.
 - Because seven was a divine number.
 - Because only seven wonders were built.
- Why are modern wonders not considered to be as breathtaking as ancient wonders?
 - Because ancient wonders were much more difficult to build.
 - Because erecting a building now is more difficult than it used to be.
 - Because erecting a building is as difficult now as it used to be a long time ago.
 - Because there isn't any space left for new wonders.

**Let's Practice!**

Have you ever thought about visiting any of the Seven Wonders?

Instructions: Use the Words from the word bank to correctly complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

only just / recently admired / just visited / recently changed / just started / recently

- If you think that people have _____ making lists about "the most" and "the best", you are wrong.
- We have _____ imagined it to be a modern pastime.
- I have _____ looked into the list the ancient Greeks made of the world's seven wonders.
- It has _____ again!
- Even so I have _____ three of the seven ancient sites.
- One more I have _____ in a museum setting.





Extension Activity

Choose a wonder for the modern world.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online to look at the modern seven wonders of the world.
- Go through them and decide whether you think they are indeed the top seven.
- Find another site that you think can be added to this list.
- Find out about the site and write up a short 'sales pitch' to convince others that this should be added to the list.
- Bring your sales pitch to class and read it to a group.
- Listen to other pitches.
- As a group decide which of the pitches were best and explain why.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I look at the seven wonders of the modern world, then choose another site that I think can be added to this list.

☐ ☐

I write a short 'sales pitch' to convince others that this should be added to the list.

☐ ☐

I read my 'sales pitch' to others in the class.

☐ ☐

I listen to other pitches.

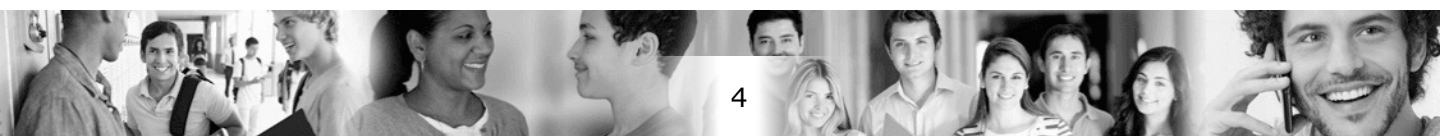
☐ ☐

I discuss with the group which pitches are the best and say why.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- pastime** (noun): a way to spend time, a hobby
e.g. We have only just imagined making lists to be a modern pastime.
- to cite** (verb): to mention as an example
e.g. The ancient Greeks cited the Great Pyramid, the Hanging Gardens of Babylon as two of the Seven Wonders.
- perfection** (noun): the state of being flawless, or without error
e.g. In the ancient world, the number seven symbolized perfection.
- to exist** (verb): to be, live
e.g. People are now voting on which seven buildings of the 200 still existing are more amazing than the others.
- to erect** (verb): to build
e.g. It was more difficult in ancient times to erect such edifices than it was as time passed.
- edifice** (noun): a building or structure
e.g. It was more difficult in ancient times to erect such edifices than it was as time passed.
- taxing** (adjective): physically or mentally difficult
e.g. Travel over great distances was much more taxing in ancient times compared to now, so tourists were far more adventurous than most are today.
- bucket list** (noun): a list of experiences someone wants to have before they die
e.g. Now that a more modern version of the seven ancient sights is being put together, I will have to start a new bucket list.





Learning Points

Adverbial Clauses of Comparison: Degree

When you compare objects or people to other objects or people, you can use adverbial phrases.

These make your writing and speaking sound more sophisticated and dynamic.

Adverbial clauses of comparison of degree answer the questions *how much?*, *how little?* or *how many?*.

They are introduced by the subordinating conjunction *than*, or by the relative adverb *as*.

For example:

*She is older **than her sister**.*

*He is as handsome **as he is intelligent**.*

Examples:

- *Their purpose was to provide travelers with a better guide than they previously had to the world's most fascinating and unique structures.*
- *People are now voting on which seven buildings of the 200 still existing are more amazing than the others.*
- *Are these new structures more breathtaking than those the ancients chose?*
- *Tourists were far more adventurous in ancient times than most are today.*





Learning Points

Present Perfect for Unusual Events

You can use the Present Perfect tense to talk about unusual events since you use this tense to connect past events with present situations.

You use the Present Perfect tense:

- for something that started in the past and continues in the present:

They've been married for almost thirty years.

He has lived in Toronto all his life.

- for something that has only recently happened:

It has recently ***changed*** again!

Even so ***I have*** just ***visited*** three of the seven ancient sites.

One more ***I have*** recently ***admired*** in a museum setting.

You use the words *just*, *only just* and *recently* in these contexts.

- when we are talking about our experience up to the present:

Have you ***ever*** wondered why they chose seven?

Have you ***ever*** noticed this list changes?

You often use the adverb *ever* to ask or talk about experience up to the present and you use *never* for the negative form.

Take a look at the examples from the text:

Examples:

- *If you think that people have just started making lists about the "the most" and "the best", you are wrong.*
- *We have only just imagined it to be a modern pastime.*
- *I have recently looked into the list the ancient Greeks made of the world's seven wonders.*

